

Concepts and Principles of Holistic Health Care

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Learning objectives

Upon completion of this chapter, the student will be able to:

- Define some terms
- List importance of Holistic Care in Nursing
- List benefits of Holistic Care in Nursing
- Identify Principles of holistic health care
- Recognize roles and responsibilities of a holistic nurse



Out lines

- Introduction
- Definitions
- Importance of Holistic Care in Nursing
- Benefits of Holistic Care in Nursing
- Principles of holistic health care

Concepts and principles of Holistic Health Care

Introduction:

The idea of caring for the entire person, not just their physical body, is one that dates back to Florence Nightingale. Florence Nightingale devotion was to care for those who could not care for themselves. She encouraged holistic care by recognizing the importance of environment touch, light, scents, music and silent reflection in therapy process.

Concepts and principles of Holistic Health Care

Presently, there are two major challenges that are emerging in nursing:

- **The first:** is integrate the concepts of technology, mind, and spirit into nursing practice;
- **The second:** is create and integrate models for health care that guide the healing of self and others.

So

Holistic nursing is the most complete way to conceptualize and practice professional nursing.

Concepts and principles of Holistic Health Care

- In Greek, Holos means wholeness. From the Greek root, holism is thus to do with the whole unit rather than as a sum of its individual parts. **Holistic health care** is an approach to wellness that considers the whole person, body, mind, and spirit. It focuses on achieving optimal health by addressing the underlying causes of illness and promoting balance in all aspects of life. It takes a more comprehensive approach. It recognizes that physical health is interconnected with mental, emotional, and spiritual well-being.

Concepts and Definitions



Health

As defined by World Health Organization it defined as a state of complete physical, mental & social Wellbeing, not merely the absence of disease.

The new definition

Considers health as a dynamic state of well-being with different levels of functional abilities at different point in time. **So a diabetic patient no doubt has a disease, but there are times when the client feels well and can be called healthy**

Concepts and Definitions

Disease:

Any harmful deviation from the normal structural or functional state of an organism, generally associated with certain signs and symptoms and differing in nature from physical injury. A diseased organism commonly exhibits signs or symptoms indicative of its abnormal state.

Concepts and Definitions

Homeostasis:

The balance or stability of the body, mind and spirit.

Health Promotion:

Activities and preventive measures such as immunizations, fitness/exercise programs, breast self-exam, appropriate nutrition, relaxation, stress management, social support, prayer, meditation, healing rituals, cultural practices, and promoting environmental health and safety.

Concepts and Definitions

Holistic care:

Is an approach to health care that addresses the patient's physical, emotional, social and spiritual needs. This type of care is comprehensive; rather than aiming to treat illness, holistic care aims to enhance the overall well-being and quality of life of an individual.



Concepts and Definitions

Holistic Nursing:



Is the concept of caring of a person as a whole. The aim is to restore the patient as a whole. Holistic nursing emphasizes on the nurses taking into account the connection between mind, body, emotion, spirit, social, cultural, environment and past relationships in order to restore the patient to a whole. **Holistic Nursing: also,** is defined as “all nursing practice that has healing the whole person as its goal”

Concepts and Definitions

Holism:

Is a concept that is found in holistic nursing which means treating a human being as a whole. For nurses to deliver holistic care, it is important to differentiate and understand healing and curing.

Concepts and Definitions

Curing:

Focuses on mainly eradicating what is causing the illness this includes the use of medicine in order to find a physical cure to a disease.

Healing:

Is mainly the concept of holistic nursing focuses on finding balance in the body, mind, and spirit in a human being. The best outcome for a patient is when the two healing and curing are combined.

Concepts and Definitions

Holistic Nurse:

A nurse who recognizes and integrates body-mind-spirit principles and modalities in daily life and clinical practice.

Holistic Caring Process:

A circular process that involves six steps which may occur simultaneously. These parts are assessment, patterns/challenges/needs, outcomes, therapeutic care plan, implementation, and evaluation.

Importance of Holistic Care in Nursing

- Improving the quality of care for all.
- Providers and researchers have learned from historical applications of health care and
- Developed a comprehensive model for enhancing the quality of life and health of populations.
- Enhance the health of all populations
- Improve preventative care
- Reduce treatment costs
- Encourage respect for the dignity and humanity of those receiving care.

Benefits of Holistic Care in Nursing

- Help destigmatize mental health care
- Honor the body's natural healing intelligence
- Respect cultural differences and traditional healing methods
- Teach the value of preventative health
- Decrease the use of invasive procedures
- Shed light on economic, social and political barriers in health
- Empower practitioners to bring their humanity to health care

Key Principles of Holistic Healing

The Mind-Body-Spirit Connection: The mind, body, and spirit are interconnected, and each one influences the other. For example, emotional stress can manifest as physical illness, and physical illness can affect mental health. Holistic health emphasizes treating the whole person, not just the isolated symptoms or conditions.

Key Principles of Holistic Healing

Self-Healing: The body has an innate ability to heal itself when given the proper conditions. Holistic health care promotes practices that enhance the body's natural healing processes, such as proper nutrition, exercise, and emotional support.

Prevention Over Cure: Preventing disease and promoting wellness are key goals of holistic health care. This involves lifestyle changes, stress management, regular exercise, healthy eating, and regular self-care practices.

Key Principles of Holistic Healing

Personalized Treatment: Holistic practitioners treat individuals, not just diseases. Care is tailored to the unique physical, emotional, and spiritual needs of each person, considering their background, lifestyle, and preferences.

Integration of Various Therapies: Holistic health care incorporates a wide range of therapies, including conventional medicine, complementary therapies (such as acupuncture, massage, and herbal medicine), and lifestyle changes. The idea is to use the most appropriate treatment modalities to support the person's overall well-being.

Key Principles of Holistic Healing

Balance and Harmony: Achieving balance between the different aspects of life (work, relationships, self-care, and spiritual practice) is essential for maintaining health. Imbalance in any area can lead to stress, illness, or disease.

Individuality: Holistic health care practitioners focus patient care on the unique needs and nature of the person who has an illness rather than the illness that has the person.

Key Principles of Holistic Healing

Teaching by example: Holistic healthcare practitioners continually work toward the personal incorporation of the principles of holistic health, which then profoundly influence the quality of the healing relationship.



Learning opportunities: All life experiences including birth, joy, suffering and the dying process are profound learning opportunities for both patients and healthcare practitioners.

A top-down view of a desk with various items. In the center is a white spiral-bound notebook with the text "ANY QUESTIONS?" in bold, black, sans-serif font. Above the notebook are black-rimmed glasses. To the left is a small potted succulent with green, fleshy leaves. To the right are two yellow sticky notes, one of which has a red pencil resting on it. Below the notebook is a black pen. To the left of the notebook is a small yellow flower and a black object. The background is a light-colored, textured surface.

**ANY
QUESTIONS?**

Short Quiz

The primary focus of holistic health care is:

- a. Treating only the symptoms of illness
- b. Physical, emotional, mental, and spiritual well-being
- c. Relying solely on medication for treatment
- d. Ignoring modern medical practices

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Enumerate 3 Benefits of Holistic Care in Nursing

1.
2.
3.

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A rectangular, light brown paper tag with a hole on the left side, through which a dark, fibrous string is threaded. The tag is placed on a rough, light-colored wooden surface. Several bright green, serrated leaves are scattered around the tag, some in the foreground and some in the background, creating a natural, rustic feel. The background is softly blurred.

Thank
you!